From these thinkers I learned how to ask — not just what to cite.

Intellectual provenance, not citation dump. Each entry names a question I would not have asked without them.

Thinkers	From them, I learned to ask…	Where it shows up
Takens, Sauer, Yorke *embedding theory* *Takens 1981 · Sauer–Yorke–Casdagli 1991*	…whether the data's latent dynamics could be reconstructed from a sufficiently rich observation function — and whether that reconstruction is measurable on real ERPs.	***Exp B***
Maass, Natschläger, Markram *liquid state machines* *Maass, Natschläger, Markram 2002*	…what kind of dynamical state space a useful reservoir must possess, and what separation property it must exhibit for distinct inputs.	***Exp B premise · Ch. 5 architecture***
Jaeger, Lukoševičius *Echo State Network theory* *Jaeger 2001 · Lukoševičius–Jaeger 2009*	…whether the reservoir's response to input was consistent enough to be readable — and how to measure that consistency rather than assume it.	***Exp A***
Oseledec, Benettin, Wolf *Lyapunov spectra & numerical methods* *Oseledec 1968 · Benettin et al. 1980 · Wolf et al. 1985*	…what stability MEANS along a driven trajectory — and how to compute it when the analytic Jacobian is undefined at threshold events.	***Exp A method***
Bullmore, Sporns *graph-theoretic neuroscience* *Bullmore & Sporns 2009*	…whether the brain's spatial structure could be operationalized as a measurable graph — and whether that graph carries clinical information that survives nullification.	***Ch. 5 graph construction · Exp D***
Marder, Krakauer et al. *philosophy of neuroscience* *Marder 2015 · Krakauer, Ghazanfar, Gomez-Marin, MacIver, Poeppel 2017*	…whether benchmark accuracy is what we should optimize for in clinical neuroscience — and what we lose when interpretability becomes the trade variable.	***Methodological Refusals · J contributions***